

with them... we're still wondering whether those fish would survive our clean municipal water here in India!

PATCHING AWAY

Windows Media DRM Patch Needed

There's a little application called FreeUse4WM that is causing quite a stir. Basically, what this utility does is remove the copy-protection of files that use Windows Media Digital Rights Management (DRM), in protest of Microsoft's "big brother" behaviour.

At the time of writing, no patch had been released, and a lot of services had been disrupted. Most notably, British Sky Broadcasting (BSkyB), a large player in satellite TV and broadband in the UK, had to stop their broadband movie service

Of Bitchfests, Beanbags, And Bums

There is a beanbag in our office. Ed, who is a potato, had ordered it for himself, but Vishal, being new here, innocently thought he had equal rights to it. He's been roaming the aisles lugging it around, and plonks it down ever so often so as to sit upon it. The thing has now taken on the ungainly contours of his bum.

Meanwhile, Agent 001 was bitching about brands, and the designers and layout chaps were bitching about too much work. (65 graphics cards and 43 laptops, for God's sake!) All courtesy you, our readers—you've come to expect too much from us. We're pretty much sick of Shivilal bitching about product tables, and Pillaiji bitching about Ed's "Are we there yet?", so we're requesting you to stop asking us for more and more reviews. It's just too much work.

So that's us bitching right here about you guys—see, at least we don't lie and say we love you. (Heh—just kidding! Really!)

Priorities vary. Ed wants things finished the day before, so there is some bitching going on there—Ed wouldn't mind defenestrating some cards if it helped his cause. Michael, much to Sanket's dismay, wants to play *all* games on *all* cards before pronouncing a verdict:

Sanket: Write out the table already!

Mike: But I haven't even finished the second lev...

Sanket: But the bloody mag has to get out there on the bloody stands!

So that's the way it went, this whole bloody issue. Ed shot Vishal and reclaimed his beanbag, and is hoping Vishal hadn't f**ted too much.

DIGIT DIARY

because of FreeUse4WM.

A notice on their site proclaimed, "In order to make an essential update to the Sky by Broadband security system, we are sorry that access to all movies and some sports content has been temporarily suspended."

Microsoft said they were

working on a fix, and all service providers need not worry about patching, because Windows Media DRM comes with an inbuilt upgrade facility that would patch the security system once the patch was available.

We don't know about you, but we could have sworn we heard Steve Jobs

chuckling, all the way here in India. Apple, which uses the FairPlay DRM for its content, is sitting pretty for the moment. However, FairPlay has had it's share of problems and patches in the past, and, we suspect, will do so in the future as well! ☒

Blog WATCH

Leopard vs. Vista is the topic of many blog posts—as we'd expected. And everyone's talking about Apple's new offerings and Nintendo's Wii, of course

Mark Cuban

<http://snipurl.com/oct01>
(<http://www.blogmaverick.com/2006/09/12/new-apple-announcement/>)

New Apple Announcement

...the iPod interface is now viewable on your HDTV. Cable and Satellite companies are working hard, spending tens of millions of dollars to optimize their Programming Guides to incorporate Video On Demand, DVR ability, Internet Content, Purchase of content and TV Programming Guides... I think that the Apple interface, because it already has tens of millions of consumers trained to buy content on impulse, has to have the edge.

Chris Pirillo

<http://snipurl.com/oct02>
(<http://chris.pirillo.com/2006/09/08/leopard-vs-windows-vista/>)

Leopard vs. Windows Vista

"I challenge you to name what in Leopard justifies \$149. Because I sure can't think of none." Apparently, you're not thinking hard enough—or you haven't done your homework. ...Apple issues security updates constantly. This isn't a service pack, dude. These are not trivial upgrades. You combine the features of this list with better parental control, seamless 64-bit compatibilities, wider accessibility, and...

Ben Kuchera

<http://snipurl.com/oct08>
(<http://arstechnica.com/journals/thumbs.ars/2006/9/15/5302>)

Are Nintendo's price and... a wise move?

So Nintendo has surprised most of us by announcing the launch date for the Wii as November 19, at \$250. They won't be beating Sony to launch, and the price is a little higher than most people were hoping for. Of course prices are always higher than we'd like, but \$200 was considered the sweet spot for making the system almost an impulse buy for early adopters. They're bundling Wii Sports, but will that help to sell?

Trent Lapinski

<http://snipurl.com/rsp1>
(<http://www.valleywag.com/tech/myspace/what-news-corp-doesnt-want-you-to-know-about-myspace-condensed-edition-199668.php>)

What News Corp. doesn't want you to know about MySpace

1. MySpace is NOT a viral success. 2. MySpace.com is Spam 2.0. MySpace has spawned an incredibly successful twist on the age-old art of self-promotion. 3. Tom Anderson did NOT create MySpace. 4. MySpace's CEO Chris DeWolfe is connected to a past of spam and shady business associates...